

FOODPULSE

Brand Guide

A complete reference
for color, typography,
voice, and brand
modes — built to
scale.

Version 1.0 · 2026 ·
foodpulse.co · Font:
Montserrat (free forever)



01 — COLOR SYSTEM

The Palette

Every color has a job. The deep green anchors the brand in nature and authority. The warm accents create appetite and energy. Trust Blue and Cool Sage give the platform a register to shift into when content demands credibility over warmth. This palette operates in two modes, Editorial and Scientific, described in Section 03.

Primary Greens

Deep Green #003317 PRIMARY · BRAND ANCHOR	Teal Green #2B7A6B PRIMARY · INTERACTIVE	Support Green #245F55 PRIMARY · SUPPORTING

Credibility Layer

Trust Blue #2A5F8F SCIENTIFIC MODE · EVIDENCE & DATA NEW	Cool Sage #7A9E8E SCIENTIFIC MODE · SECONDARY SURFACES NEW

Accent & Neutrals

Honey Gold #F2B705 CTAS · HIGHLIGHTS · ACCENT RULES	Burnt Orange #E57A2B △ PHOTOGRAPHY & EDITORIAL ONLY	Mint White #E1FFED SOFT PANELS · CARDS · DIAGRAMS	White #FFFFFF PRIMARY CANVAS	Dark Charcoal #24302A PRIMARY TEXT · OUTLINES

Color Usage Map

COLOR	PRIMARY USE	NEVER USE FOR
Deep Green #003317	Hero backgrounds, nav, footers, major section anchors, graphic shapes, buttons	Body copy (too dark at small sizes)
Teal Green #2B7A6B	Icons, charts, subheadings, interactive elements, links, hover states	Large area background fills
Support Green #245F55	Body text on light, borders, card outlines, subtle dividers	Headings (too mid-tone for authority)

COLOR	PRIMARY USE	NEVER USE FOR
Honey Gold #F2B705	Primary CTAs, metrics, accent rules, pull quote borders, inline emphasis (sparingly)	Body text on white, contrast too low; large backgrounds
Trust Blue #2A5F8F	Scientific mode: evidence badges, glossary tags, calculator labels, data tables, citation callouts, chart series	Food or recipe contexts, keep blue in the science layer
Cool Sage #7A9E8E	Scientific mode: secondary UI surfaces, category tags, muted icon fills, form panels	Headings or primary CTAs
Burnt Orange #E57A2B	Photography/illustration warmth, very occasional editorial flourishes	Data viz, calculators, evidence UIs, navigation, use sparingly
Mint White #E1FFED	Soft panels, cards, diagrams, section backgrounds	Primary text (contrast too low)
Charcoal #24302A	Primary text on light, outlines, table headers on light backgrounds	Text on dark green backgrounds

Note: When pairing text on Honey Gold, always use Deep Green #003317 for maximum legibility.

02 — TYPOGRAPHY

Montserrat

One font with usage of six weights. Montserrat is free Google Fonts with OFL license. It's available on the web, in Canva, in print and for any contractor. Hierarchy is created entirely through weight, size, tracking and color.

Type Scale

TITLE 48px · ExtraBold 800 · tracking -0.03em · lh 1.05	Explore All Things Food	USED FOR Hero headline, page title Canva: ExtraBold
SUBTITLE 22px · Light 300 · tracking 0 · lh 1.4	Your hub for evidence-based food education	USED FOR Hero subtitle, page intro text Canva: Light
HEADING 30px · Bold 700 · tracking -0.02em · lh 1.15	Why Your Food Environment Matters	USED FOR Article H1, section titles Canva: Bold
SUBHEADING 22px · SemiBold 600 · tracking -0.01em · lh 1.25	What the Research Shows	USED FOR Article H2, card titles Canva: SemiBold
SECTION HEADER 11px · SemiBold 600 · +0.12em · ALL CAPS	LATEST ARTICLES · EXPLORE TOPICS	USED FOR Section labels, nav eyebrows Canva: SemiBold + All Caps
BODY 17px · Regular 400 · tracking 0 · lh 1.8	Healthy eating is shaped by your food environment far more than willpower alone.	USED FOR Articles, guides, glossary, all long-form content Canva: Regular
QUOTE 18px · Light Italic 300 · tracking 0 · lh 1.65	"Food environment is a stronger predictor of diet quality than knowledge alone."	USED FOR Pull quotes, research callouts, expert statements Canva: Light Italic

CAPTION <i>12px · Medium 500 · tracking +0.02em · lh 1.5</i>	Fig. 1 — Source: Journal of Nutrition, 2024. All data peer-reviewed.	USED FOR Image captions, footnotes, source attributions Canva: Medium
--	--	---

Weight Range — Use Only These 6

300 · Light	FoodPulse — Evidence-Based Food Education
400 · Regular	FoodPulse — Evidence-Based Food Education
500 · Medium	FoodPulse — Evidence-Based Food Education
600 · SemiBold	FoodPulse — Evidence-Based Food Education
700 · Bold	FoodPulse — Evidence-Based Food Education
800 · ExtraBold	FoodPulse — Evidence-Based Food Education

03 — BRAND MODES

Editorial & Scientific

FoodPulse operates across two distinct content registers. The palette shifts to signal which mode the reader is in: warm and food-connected for editorial content, measured and credible for science-backed content. The same brand, two expressions. It's like how Stripe uses vibrant gradients on its marketing pages but shifts to a restrained blue-grey system inside its Dashboard — same company, different context, intentional palette shift.

Editorial Mode

Default — articles, About, landing pages, recipes, story-driven content

Colors in use:

- Deep Green #003317 — hero backgrounds, nav, major section anchors
- Teal Green #2B7A6B — icons, subheadings, interactive elements, charts
- Support Green #245F55 — body text, borders, card outlines
- Honey Gold #F2B705 — CTAs, pull quote borders, accent rules
- Mint White #E1FFED — soft panel and card backgrounds
- Burnt Orange #E57A2B — very sparingly, photography warmth only

Switch to this mode when:

- This is the default mode for most pages
- Articles, "Start Here", About, landing pages
- Story-driven posts, recipes, coaching pages
- Newsletter and social content

Scientific Mode

Evidence pages, calculators, glossary, data tools, citation-heavy content

Colors in use:

- Deep Green #003317 — primary headings, key anchors (unchanged)
- Trust Blue #2A5F8F — evidence badges, labels, calculator interfaces, data tables, citation callouts, chart series
- Cool Sage #7A9E8E — secondary UI surfaces, category tags, form panel backgrounds
- Honey Gold #F2B705 — CTAs remain gold (unchanged)
- Charcoal #24302A — all primary text (unchanged)
- Burnt Orange — excluded entirely from scientific UI

Switch to this mode when:

- Page includes data, citations or a calculator
- Glossary definition or evidence badge is present
- Content references NIH, WHO or peer-reviewed sources
- User is interacting with a nutrition tool

Mode Switching Rules

RULE	DETAIL
Accent stays consistent	Honey Gold #F2B705 is your CTA color in both modes — never swap it out
Orange stays out of Scientific	Burnt Orange is excluded entirely from any page with data, citations, or calculators
Keep accents under 10%	Trust Blue and Gold should occupy no more than 10% of any layout — they are accents, not fills
Text colors never change	Charcoal for body text, Deep Green for headings — both modes, always
Mode per page, not per component	Decide the mode at page level. Do not mix modes within a single page
Scientific does not mean cold	Deep Green is still present. The shift is in the supporting colors, not the entire palette

04 — BRAND VOICE

How FoodPulse Speaks

FoodPulse's voice sits at the intersection of scientific credibility and everyday accessibility. It is informed but never condescending, warm but never frivolous. Every piece of content should feel like advice from a knowledgeable friend — not a lecture from a nutritionist.

The Four Voice Principles

Informed, not academic

"The research on seed oils is more nuanced than social media suggests, here's what the evidence shows."

Lead with the real finding. Acknowledge the noise. Never simplify to the point of inaccuracy.

Practical, not preachy

"You don't need to overhaul your diet. Start with one thing you'll actually do."

FoodPulse respects that people have real lives. Advice is actionable and non-judgmental.

Direct, not blunt

"Most detox products don't do what they claim. Your liver already handles this."

Call out misinformation clearly, but without condescension. The reader is smart.

Curious, not anxious

"We're still learning a lot about the gut microbiome and that's actually exciting."

Lean into the complexity of nutrition science without generating fear or confusion.

Tone by Content Type

CONTENT TYPE	TONE	REGISTER
Research articles	Authoritative, measured, precise	"Studies show..." · "The evidence suggests..." · "According to..."
Practical tips	Warm, direct, encouraging	"Here's how to..." · "A simple rule..." · "Most people find that..."
Glossary definitions	Clear, concise, neutral	Plain language. No jargon without explanation.
Newsletter	Conversational, curious, personal	First person allowed. "This week I noticed..." · "Worth reading:"

CONTENT TYPE	TONE	REGISTER
Social captions	Punchy, insightful, never clickbait	Lead with the insight, not the teaser. Never "You won't believe..."

05 — USAGE RULES

Do's & Don'ts

These rules protect the brand as it scales. Every contractor, designer, and content partner should review this section before working on any FoodPulse asset.

Typography

DO	DON'T
✓ Use Montserrat exclusively across all brand touchpoints ✓ Use weight contrast to create hierarchy — ExtraBold for titles, Light for subtitles ✓ Use negative tracking (−0.02em to −0.04em) at display sizes 28px and above ✓ Use Light Italic for pull quotes with a Honey Gold left border ✓ Set body text at 17px minimum with 1.8 line height	✗ Introduce a second typeface — not even for data, captions, or UI ✗ Use positive tracking on headings — it weakens the authority ✗ Set body text below 15px ✗ Use ALL CAPS for anything other than section labels and nav eyebrows ✗ Use weights outside the 300–800 range

Color

DO	DON'T
✓ Use Deep Green #003317 as the dominant presence on dark surfaces ✓ Use Honey Gold for CTAs, highlights, and quote borders only ✓ Use Trust Blue in Scientific mode for anything evidence or data-related ✓ Use Mint White #E1FFED as a surface color for cards and section backgrounds ✓ Reserve Burnt Orange exclusively for photography and editorial flourishes	✗ Use Honey Gold for body text on white — contrast is too low ✗ Use Burnt Orange in Scientific mode, data viz, or calculator UI ✗ Use more than 3 brand colors in a single UI component ✗ Introduce new colors without updating this guide first ✗ Mix Editorial and Scientific mode colors on the same page

Voice & Content

DO	DON'T
✓ Cite sources — NIH, WHO, and peer-reviewed journals build trust ✓ Acknowledge scientific uncertainty when it genuinely exists ✓ Write headlines that deliver the insight, not tease it	✗ Use fear, urgency, or alarmism — even when the topic warrants concern ✗ Publish unverified health claims or present opinion as research ✗ Use clickbait headline structures ("You won't believe...")

- ✓ Use plain language for all glossary and tool content
- ✓ Write section labels in ALL CAPS with Trust Blue color

- ✗ Over-simplify nuanced nutrition topics for engagement
- ✗ Use the brand to promote specific products or supplements

06 — QUICK REFERENCE

At a Glance

Here's everything as a standalone reference.

Color Tokens

TOKEN
--color-primary
--color-teal
--color-support
--color-sage
--color-blue
--color-gold
--color-orange
--color-mint
--color-dark

Type Tokens

TOKEN	VALUE
--font	Montserrat
--size-title	48px · 800 · -0.03em
--size-subtitle	22px · 300 · 0
--size-heading	30px · 700 · -0.02em
--size-subheading	22px · 600 · -0.01em
--size-label	11px · 600 · +0.12em caps
--size-body	17px · 400 · lh 1.8
--size-quote	18px · 300i · lh 1.65
--size-caption	12px · 500 · +0.02em

Brand Mode Summary

	EDITORIAL MODE	SCIENTIFIC MODE
Primary colors	Deep Green, Teal, Support Green	Deep Green (unchanged), Trust Blue, Cool Sage
Accent	Honey Gold	Honey Gold (unchanged)
Surfaces	White, Mint White	White, light blue-tinted panels
Orange use	Very sparingly, photography only	Excluded entirely
When to use	Articles, landing pages, recipes	Calculators, glossary, citations, data tools

FoodPulse Brand Guide

Version 1.0 · © 2026 · For internal use and approved partners

foodpulse.co